Vacant-Pad Fill Calculator

Property: _____

Date: _____

Part D: Prove the numbers.

Takes in: your walk counts and verified rent

Hands to: AS-07, AS-16

Built for MHC lot fill. For RV transient sites, use its sibling: Transient Site Fill Calculator (AS-10R).

The seller gets zero credit for unrealized upside. Vacant pads are not value. They are an unfunded construction project with an unproven market. You pay for income in place. The fill is yours to fund, execute, and earn.

Upside credit rule: the seller gets zero credit for unrealized upside. Price the park on income in place.

Three fill paths

Path	You pay	Time	Risk
Resident brings their own home	Pad prep, permits, hookup	1 to 3 months	Low cost, slow fill
You buy and place a home	Home, transport, set, hookup	2 to 6 months	Capital heavy, faster
RV pad build-out	Pedestal, sewer, water, surface	1 to 4 months	Permits and power capacity

Per-path math: run your chosen path

Cost per pad ($) - two local contractor quotes first: ____ **Pads to fill:** _____

Plan cost ($): _____

Likely cost: plan + 50% ($): _____ **Bad cost: 2 to 3x plan ($):** _____

The multiplier is a prudence heuristic, not a measurement (rule of thumb, verify locally). No number is trusted until two local contractors quote it.

Incremental NOI per filled pad ($/yr): _____ **Total incremental NOI ($/yr):** _____

NOI, not gross rent. Payback divided by gross overstates the return by the expense ratio.

Yield on cost = incremental NOI / plan cost. Value created = incremental NOI / exit cap rate. Payback = stressed cost / incremental NOI.

Yield on cost (%): _____ **Value created ($):** _____

Months to stabilize: _____ **Fund it from:** _____

☐ If the fill stalls at 50%, the debt still gets paid from: write the source.

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Front page 1: the paths and the per-path math. Front page 2: the lease-up curve and the stall check.

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Lease-up curve: pads filled by month

Month	Pads filled	Cumulative NOI ($/yr)
3		
6		
9		
12		
15		
18		

Read the curve against the debt. A fill that needs perfect execution to carry its own loan is not upside, it is a second deal hiding inside the first.

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Worked example: Maple Bend Estates (fictional)

4 vacant pads. Path: you buy and place a used home. Cost per pad: home $22,000 + transport and set $5,000 + hookup and permits $3,000 = $30,000. Check: 22,000 + 5,000 + 3,000 = 30,000. Plan cost for 4: 30,000 x 4 = $120,000. Likely (plan + 50%): $180,000. Bad (2.5x plan): $300,000.

Incremental NOI per filled pad: lot rent $410 x 12 = $4,920 gross, less 35% expense ratio (rule of thumb, verify locally): 4,920 x 0.65 = $3,198/yr. Four pads: 3,198 x 4 = $12,792/yr. Yield on cost: 12,792 / 120,000 = 10.66%. Value created at an 8% exit cap: 12,792 / 0.08 = $159,900, which is $39,900 over plan cost (159,900 - 120,000). Payback on plan: 120,000 / 12,792 = 9.4 years. On likely cost: 180,000 / 12,792 = 14.1 years.

Lease-up: 1 pad by month 3, 2 by month 6, 3 by month 9, 4 by month 12. Months to stabilize: 12. Stall check at 50%: 2 pads = $6,396/yr against debt service of about $12,045/yr on the $120,000 at 8% over 20 years. The fill does not carry the loan at half speed. Fund it from reserves or park cash flow, never from the upside.

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The Doctrine

The belief this shatters: vacant pads are upside. A vacant pad is an unfunded construction project with an unproven market, sitting on dirt you already paid for. Upside belongs to whoever funds it and executes it, which is you, after closing, with your money and your risk. The rule: price the park on income in place, give the seller zero credit for what is not built, and compare your yield on cost to the exit cap rate. The spread between them is your pay for execution risk. If the spread is thin and the fill stalls at half speed, the debt still has to get paid, and the plan has to say from where.

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